- *Classic Load Balancer (CLB)*—HTTP, HTTPS, TCP, TCP TLS

Consider the CLB deprecated. As a rule of thumb, use the ALB whenever the HTTP/HTTPS protocol is all you need, and the NLB for all other scenarios.

NOTE The ELB service doesn't have an independent management console. It's integrated into the EC2 Management Console.

Load balancers can be used with more than web servers—you can use load balancers in front of any systems that deal with request/response-style communication, as long as the protocol is based on TCP.

14.1.1 Setting up a load balancer with virtual machines

AWS shines when it comes to integrating services. In chapter 13, you learned about Auto Scaling groups. You'll now put an ALB in front of an Auto Scaling group to decouple traffic to web servers by removing the dependency between your users and the EC2 instance's public IP address. The Auto Scaling group will make sure you always have two web servers running. As you learned in chapter 13, that's the way to protect against downtime caused by hardware failure. Servers that are started in the Auto Scaling group can automatically register with the ALB.

Figure 14.2 shows what the setup will look like. The interesting part is that the EC2 instances are no longer accessible directly from the public internet, so your users don't know about them. They don't know if there are two or 20 EC2 instances running behind the load